3Col — Call Sheet

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> **READ THIS BEFORE YOU PLAN THE CALL**
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> **The SBDC is a small-business shop, not a grants office.** Their published services are business plan development, technology commercialization, market research, loan application review and SBIR/STTR. Grant writing is not on the list, and neither the Wyoming Business Council, community grants, nor nonprofit projects appear anywhere on it.
> So the half hour you booked to solve the sponsor problem may not be able to solve it. But the door you have opened leads somewhere better, and it costs you nothing to walk through both.

THE REFRAME, AND IT IS THE POINT OF THIS SHEET

You have been treating 3Col as a community pilot that needs a $10,000 grant, and that path has a blocker you cannot clear: individuals cannot apply, so you need a sponsor. **To the SBDC, 3Col is a business** — you have a product, a method, a brand, a tagline and a company name. Said that way, their entire menu opens:

- **Market research, free.** Their own research service, at no cost. This is worth real money and you would use the output twice — once for the business, once as the evidence base in any grant narrative you write later.
- **Business plan development and technology commercialization.** Named services. This is what they are actually for.
- **No sponsor needed.** As a business you are the applicant. The blocker that has stalled you since September does not exist on this path.

One caution: they also list SBIR/STTR, the federal R&D grants, and the headline numbers are large. Do not get attached. SBIR wants a research project answering a specific agency's posted topic. Generating websites with existing AI tools is probably not that. Ask the question, but treat a yes as a surprise.

> **THE ONE OUTCOME THAT STILL MATTERS**
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> Walk out with **a named local sponsor to approach, and the name of someone there.** The Community Economic Growth Grant funds communities and organizations, not individuals. Until a city, county, library, chamber or economic development organization agrees to be the applicant, there is no application. Ask even though it is off their menu — she covers Washakie and will know the landscape informally.

BEFORE THE 23RD — ONE ERRAND, AND IT DOUBLES THE VALUE OF THE CALL

Thirteen days is enough to walk into this with information instead of a blank. **Call Tertia at the Washakie County grants office** and ask one question: would the County consider being the applicant on a $10,000 Business Council grant for a local technology pilot? You already know her, so it costs you a phone call.

- **If she says yes or maybe** — the half hour becomes “here's my sponsor, help me write the application,” which is the best possible use of a free advisor.
- **If she says no** — you know why, and Devan can route around a specific obstacle instead of guessing at a general one.
- **If she doesn't call back** — that is information too, and question 1 below stands exactly as written.

Don't pitch her the whole program. One question, one answer, off the phone.

SAY THIS FIRST, THEN STOP TALKING

"I'm a retired technology engineer in Worland. I've built a method for generating single-topic websites with AI — the person I build it for never touches setup, they just pick a name. I call it 3Col. One-topic websites, while you wait.

I've got three running already, including one on the Worland dog ordinances. I want to run it as a pilot in Washakie County, with high school students doing the demonstrations, and I'm looking at the Business Council's Community Economic Growth Grant — about ten thousand dollars.

Two things I'd like help with. One, I think there's a real business here and I'd like to know what you'd do with it. Two, I've been looking at the Business Council's Community Economic Growth Grant for a school pilot, and I'm stuck because I'm an individual and it needs a community sponsor."

Thirty to forty seconds. Then let them ask. The temptation will be to explain how it works — don't. They'll ask if they want to know. Leading with the business is deliberate: it is the thing she is funded to help you with.

THE THREE QUESTIONS. ASK THESE BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE.

1 Which Washakie County entities have actually sponsored a Wyoming Business Council grant before, and who do I talk to there?

This is the whole call. An advisor sees these applications and knows which local bodies have the paperwork habit and which will go quiet. A name and a phone number beats any amount of advice.

2 Is the Community Economic Growth Grant actually open? The WBC page still carries a notice saying community grants are under review and will reopen by January 2024.

That notice has sat there for two years while the page still lists the March 1 and September 1 deadlines. You cannot resolve that from outside. They can, or they can call Amber Power and find out. If it is dead, you need to know Friday, not in February.

3 If this grant is the wrong instrument, what is the right one for a rural technology pilot at around ten thousand dollars?

Keep the amount and the purpose fixed, let them pick the program. They know the menu — WBC, USDA Rural Development, community foundations, the energy-impact money — and you don't. This question costs you nothing and may be worth more than the answer you came for.

4 Can you run market research on this for me, and what would you need from me to start?

A named, free service and the clearest thing she can actually give you. Ask it even if the first three go badly — it is the one request that is squarely inside her job, and the output serves both the business and any grant you write later.

IF THERE'S TIME LEFT

- **Does the sponsor have to be the fiscal agent**, holding and disbursing the money, or can they sponsor while I run it?
- **Is a match required**, and does in-kind work count? You have built three sites already and that labor may be countable.
- **Will you review the application before it goes in?** SBDC advising is free and this is exactly what it's for. Get it on the calendar before you hang up.
- **Does working with minors change anything?** The high school ambassadors are central to the pitch and may bring requirements you haven't met yet.

FACTS TO HAVE IN FRONT OF YOU

PROGRAM	MAXIMUM	DEADLINES
Community Economic Growth Grant, under WBC Rural Development Grants	$10,000	March 1 and September 1 — next is 1 March 2027
WBC CONTACT	**ELIGIBILITY**	**LIVE EXAMPLES**
Amber Power, Leadership & Engagement Manager, 307.287.9886	Communities and organizations. Not individuals.	worland-dog-law.online, washakie-ai.online, threecolumns.online
WASHAKIE COUNTY	**THE CONTRAST**	**WHO SHE IS**
~7,600 people, declining since 2000	Laramie County approved a 1.8 GW Crusoe/Tallgrass data center in Jan 2026. UW's AI4WY has ~$4M from NSF. Northern rural Wyoming: nothing.	Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill — Wyoming SBDC, Powell office, covering Big Horn, Hot Springs, Park and Washakie. dcostaca@uwyo.edu, 307-254-7755. You emailed her 6 October.
WHAT THE SBDC IS	**WHAT THEY DO**	**WHAT THEY DON'T LIST**
Hosted at the University of Wyoming, funded in part by the SBA. 31+ years, 1,000+ businesses a year. No-cost and confidential.	Business plan development, technology and product commercialization, market research, loan application review, cybersecurity, government contracting, SBIR/STTR.	Grant writing. Community or nonprofit grants. The Wyoming Business Council. None of these appear in their published services.

The contrast numbers are for legislators, not for an advisor. Hold them unless asked why rural Wyoming needs its own thing.

THE QUESTION YOU WILL BE ASKED, THAT YOU HAVE NOT SETTLED

BE READY INSIDE THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

“Is this a business or a community program?”

You have described it both ways — a county pilot needing a municipal sponsor, and a venture with business cards, a company name and students selling into their neighborhoods. Both are true. For this audience there is a right answer, and it is the business.

“It's a business. The school pilot is how I prove the method in public and find out whether there's demand — the student calls are the market test. The grant would fund the pilot; the business is the thing I'm actually building.”

That is honest, it is the answer that puts you inside her remit rather than outside it, and it loses you nothing on the grant track.

DO NOT SPEND THE HALF HOUR ON

- **How the sites are generated.** Fascinating, irrelevant to whether you can apply.
- **The dog ordinance dispute.** Show the site as a working example of the format. The signage quarrel behind it is a different story and it makes the project sound like a grievance.
- **The AI-in-Wyoming argument.** You will want to make it. It is the legislature's argument, not an advisor's, and it will eat ten minutes.
- **Demonstrating a site live.** Offer the URLs, let them look afterward. Screen-sharing burns a third of the call and you will narrate.

BEFORE YOU HANG UP

- Repeat back the sponsor name and the person to contact. Confirm the spelling.
- Ask for a follow-up slot to review the draft application.
- Ask whether they can make the introduction to the sponsor themselves. An advisor's email opens a door that a cold call does not.

Prepared 10 October 2026 · grant facts verified against wyomingbusiness.org and service list against wyomingsbdc.org the same day